

**IN THE MATTER OF PETITION OF FORD MOTOR COMPANY FOR A
DECLARATORY ORDER DETERMINING THAT FORD'S ELECTRIC VEHICLE
CHARGING SYSTEMS WITH HOME BACKUP POWER FEATURES AND DISABLED
HOME POWER MANAGEMENT FEATURES ARE NOT SUBJECT TO
INTERCONNECTION RULES**

VEHICLE-GRID INTEGRATION COUNCIL'S COMMENTS IN SUPPORT OF FORD
MOTOR COMPANY'S PETITION FOR DECLARATORY ORDER

The Vehicle-Grid Integration Council ("VGIC") respectfully submits these Comments in support of the Petition for Declaratory Order ("Petition") filed by Ford Motor Company ("Ford") on December 23, 2025.

I. INTRODUCTION

VGIC is a national 501(c)(6) non-profit trade association focused on accelerating the role of flexible electric vehicle ("EV") charging and discharging to support a more reliable, efficient, and affordable electric grid. VGIC supports Ford's request for a Declaratory Order clarifying the applicability of the Commission's Interconnection Rules to systems using Home Backup Power ("HBP") or disabled Home Power Management ("HPM") features.

II. COMMENTS

VGIC has engaged closely with automakers, utilities, third-party testing laboratories, EV charging equipment manufacturers, vehicle-grid integration ("VGI") aggregators and service providers, policy-makers, non-profit organizations, and academics since 2020 on the topic of bidirectional charging systems, including through the development of its *V2X Bidirectional Charging Systems: Best Practices for Service Connection or Interconnection*.¹ Based on this experience, the Commission granting Ford's request through a Declaratory Order would constitute a reasonable formalization and confirmation of an existing best practice already implemented and, in some cases, clarified, in other markets. VGIC agrees with the Petition's assertion that HBP feature is not an "interconnection resource" because it operates in a "break-before-make" fashion, physically isolating the home from the grid before discharging power. As noted in the Petition, the Electric Power Research Institute ("EPRI") conducted laboratory assessments confirming that the system provides backup power only after the system is properly disconnected from the grid. Moreover, this treatment is widely applied to existing home backup

¹ V2X Bidirectional Charging Systems: Best Practices for Service Connection or Interconnection. August 2022.
<https://www.vgicouncil.org/s/VGIC-Special-Initiative-2022.pdf>

systems operating in a break-before-make configuration. Because these systems are physically incapable of backfeeding the grid during operation, they cannot impact power quality or safety.

Classifying such verified, isolated systems as “interconnection resources” would impose administrative burdens without providing any grid safety benefit. As transportation electrification is expected to continue growing in Colorado, the unnecessary paperwork and administrative burden of completing and processing interconnection applications, along with the associated costs, including any application fees, for both the utility and the customer, must be considered. Without technical merit to justify these soft costs and/or application fees, they would serve only to create barriers to customer adoption with no incremental grid safety benefit.

Additionally, regarding Ford’s HPM feature (which supports grid-parallel bidirectional charging), Ford clarifies that the hardware is sold with this feature disabled. Activation requires a strict three-phase process: (1) Eligibility, (2) Interconnection & Onboarding, and (3) Final Activation.

VGIC supports the position that latent hardware capabilities should not trigger interconnection rules. Regulation should focus on *active* capabilities. Ford’s process ensures that the utility is notified and an interconnection agreement is signed *before* the device is enabled for parallel operation. This, too, echoes the existing paradigm for other customer-sited distributed energy resources, such as rooftop solar or stationary energy storage, which do not enter grid-parallel operation until the utility grants an interconnection agreement. Requiring interconnection filings for disabled hardware would unnecessarily and significantly bottleneck EV deployment in Colorado.

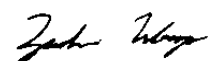
Lastly, VGIC notes that granting this Petition would align Colorado with other leading regulatory jurisdictions. For example, the Michigan Public Service Commission recently issued a declaratory ruling finding that Ford’s HBP feature does not require interconnection authorization because it prevents parallel operation. Building this type of consistency across jurisdictions is critical to reducing friction in the relatively nascent VGI solutions market, ensuring EVs remain a valuable, safe, environmentally friendly, and relatively inexpensive backup power option for Coloradoans.

III. CONCLUSION

VGIC respectfully requests that the Commission grant the Petition and issue the four determinations requested by Ford, affirming that its isolated backup systems and disabled grid-parallel features do not trigger interconnection requirements.

Respectfully submitted,

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